

Cybersecurity Career Development Roadmap

Role-aligned learning plan connecting professional development to portfolio evidence and analyst responsibilities

Career Objective

Build job-ready capability for Cybersecurity Analyst and SOC Analyst I opportunities while maintaining strong secondary alignment with GRC, IT risk, incident response, and vulnerability management. Progress is measured by demonstrable work products, not course volume alone.

Current Foundation

- Cybersecurity fundamentals covering threats, vulnerabilities, security operations, incident response, governance, identity, networks, Linux, SQL, and Python concepts.
- Analytics foundation supporting structured investigation, data quality, SQL-based analysis, visualization, and clear reporting.
- Portfolio evidence spanning security governance, controls/compliance, SOC/SIEM concepts, incident response, automation, and technical security projects.

Competency Roadmap

Priorit y	Competency	Job-ready evidence	Success standard
1	SOC investigation & SIEM	Alert investigation with query logic, timeline, evidence, severity, MITRE ATT&CK; mapping, and escalation decision.	Another analyst can reproduce the investigation and understand the decision.
2	Detection engineering	Documented detections with logic, test data, expected behavior, false positives, tuning, and ATT&CK; mapping.	Each detection has a clear purpose, validation steps, and tuning rationale.
3	Incident response	Incident record covering triage, containment recommendation, recovery, timeline, ownership, and lessons learned.	Timeline and ownership are complete; recommendations are actionable.
4	Vulnerability management	Risk-ranked findings using CVSS/context, asset criticality, owner, SLA, remediation, and validation.	Priorities reflect business context, not CVSS alone.
5	GRC / controls	Control assessment with evidence, gap, risk, owner, remediation, and validation.	Documentation is audit-ready and avoids unsupported conclusions.
6	Cloud security fundamentals	IAM, logging, network controls, secure configuration, and monitoring examples.	Security decisions demonstrate least privilege, visibility, and defense in depth.
7	Security reporting	Operational and executive views of incidents, vulnerabilities, controls, and trends.	Metrics drive decisions and distinguish activity from outcomes.

90-Day Development Sequence

- **Days 1-30 - SOC investigation evidence:** Build or refine alert-triage artifacts with logs, queries, analyst notes, severity rationale, ATT&CK; mapping, and escalation decisions.
- **Days 31-60 - Vulnerability and incident response:** Add risk prioritization, remediation ownership, validation, incident timelines, and lessons learned.
- **Days 61-90 - Cloud security and reporting:** Add IAM, logging, and network-control evidence plus concise metrics showing risk reduction, backlog aging, incident trends, and control health.

Professional Development Rules

- Prioritize one strong hands-on artifact over several shallow course completions.
- Label credentials accurately: professional certificate, course completion, exam preparation, and vendor certification are distinct.
- For every learning activity, capture a practical output that a hiring manager can review.
- Use frameworks to structure decisions rather than as keyword lists.
- Keep artifacts recruiter-readable: purpose, environment, actions, evidence, finding, recommendation, and outcome.

Target Role Alignment

Target role	Strongest evidence to show
Cybersecurity Analyst	Broad security operations, governance, analytics, and incident documentation.
SOC Analyst I / Tier 1	Alert triage, SIEM queries, event timelines, severity, escalation, and ATT&CK; mapping.
Information Security Analyst	Controls, IAM, risk, incident response, vulnerability management, and reporting.
GRC / IT Risk Analyst	Framework mapping, control testing, evidence, remediation, and risk-register thinking.
Incident Response Analyst	Incident timeline, evidence handling, containment recommendation, and lessons learned.
Vulnerability Management Analyst	Risk-ranked findings, remediation SLAs, ownership, and validation evidence.

Portfolio Readiness Standard

- Every flagship artifact clearly states the problem, environment, analyst actions, evidence reviewed, finding, recommendation, and outcome.
- Technical work includes reproducible evidence such as queries, logs, screenshots, rules, scripts, or validation results where appropriate.
- Governance work includes control objective, evidence expectation, gap, risk, owner, remediation, and closure criteria.
- All claims remain accurate, interview-defensible, and clearly distinguish hands-on work from conceptual knowledge or training.